



ARTIST OPERATIONS

Artist Onboarding & Stripe Sandbox Testing

Everything an artist does between signing up and getting paid — and how to walk the whole thing end to end in a Stripe sandbox, with test verification, without moving real money.

Version	Date	Applies to	Audience
1.0	9 August 2026	MadGigz web app (Next.js · Supabase · Stripe Connect Express)	Artists · Admin · QA

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Artist onboarding

Ten steps from a cold signup to money in your bank account. Steps 1–5 are one-off. Steps 6–10 are the cycle you repeat for every show.

1 Before you start ARTIST

Have these to hand — the flow stalls without them:

- An email address you can open right now.
- At least one social profile: **Instagram, TikTok or Twitter/X**. One is enough; more just show on your public page.
- **Proof the profile is yours** — a screenshot of Spotify for Artists, song credits showing your artist name, or a screenshot of you logged in to the social account you listed.
- For paid tickets: bank details (IBAN) and a government ID, for Stripe's checks. Spain-based accounts only at the moment.
- You must be **16 or over** to hold any MadGigz account.

2 Create your account ARTIST

Open the app and choose **I'm an Artist** on the welcome screen (direct link: `/signup?role=artist`). Choosing Artist here is what unlocks the artist tools later — a fan account cannot be converted from inside the app.

FIELD	RULES
Username	3–30 characters, letters/numbers/dots/dashes/underscores, no spaces. Shown publicly as <code>@username</code> . Availability is checked as you type.
Email	Must be reachable — the confirmation goes here.
Date of birth	16+ only. Private: it is never shown on your profile and nothing else in the app reads it.
Password	8 characters minimum.
Verification	A Cloudflare Turnstile check sits under the form. Complete it before submitting.

3 Confirm your email SYSTEM

You land on **Check your inbox** and a confirmation link is sent. Tap it if you can.

IF THE LINK SAYS IT HAS EXPIRED

It almost certainly has not. Most mail providers open links automatically to scan them, seconds after the email arrives — that scan spends the single-use token and completes your verification for you. **Your account is already verified: just go to Sign in.** The sign-in screen will say so.

4 Claim your profile ARTIST

Artists are routed straight to **Claim your profile** (`/signup/artist-profile`). If a mail scanner ate your link, sign in and the card on your profile says **Finish your artist profile** — the **Continue** button on it goes to the same form.

FIELD	REQUIRED?	NOTES
Artist name	Yes	The name fans see on posters and listings. Can differ from your username.
Bio	No	A line or two for fans browsing your shows.
Instagram / TikTok / Twitter	At least one	Filling all three is not required.
Spotify / YouTube	No	Shown on your public page if given.
Evidence file	Yes	Screenshot or document. See the accepted list below.

YOUR EVIDENCE IS PRIVATE

It goes to a private bucket and is recorded separately from your public profile. Only the MadGigz review team can open it, and it never appears anywhere on your page.

Hit **Submit for review**.

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Review and approval ADMIN

Your profile now reads **Under review**. A reviewer opens `/admin/artists`, compares your evidence against the socials and artist name you gave, and sets you to approved or rejected. You get an email either way.

STATUS	WHAT YOU CAN DO
Pending	Browse and buy tickets like any fan. No Add Show, no scanner, no posting.
Approved	Full artist toolset: Add Show, Manage Show, content posts, door scanner, payouts, public artist page.
Rejected	Fan features only. Contact us to submit stronger evidence.

APPROVAL IS THE GATE, NOT THE ROLE

Being an artist account is not enough on its own — the database itself checks for *approved* before it will let a show or a post be created. Until then the buttons are hidden because the write would be refused anyway.

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Connect payouts ARTIST

Go to **Profile** → **the settings icon** → **Payouts** → **Connect payouts**. This opens Stripe's own hosted onboarding, where you enter your details directly with Stripe — MadGigz never sees or stores your bank details or ID.

Stripe will ask for: business type (individual is normal for a solo artist), legal name and address, date of birth, a tax/ID number, a phone number to verify by SMS, a bank account (IBAN), and possibly a photo ID.

When you come back, the card shows one of three states:

BADGE	MEANING	BUTTON
Not set up	No Stripe account yet.	Connect payouts
Pending	Stripe has your account but still wants something — an ID document, a missing field, or a check still running.	Finish setup
Ready	Stripe has enabled transfers. You can sell paid tickets.	View payouts on Stripe

STUCK ON PENDING?

Press **Finish setup** — it takes you back into Stripe at exactly the outstanding item. The status also updates on its own when Stripe finishes a check, so an ID under review can flip to Ready without you doing anything.

7 Add your first show ARTIST

Profile → **Add Show**. Required: title, venue, date, time, price, capacity, description, and at least one act in the lineup (your own name is pre-filled as headliner — edit it freely, and tag other MadGigz artists so the show appears on their page too). Optional: poster image, genres, accent colour, max tickets per order (default 6).

Two ways to ticket

MODE	WHAT HAPPENS
Sell on MadGigz	Fans check out in-app, tickets are issued with a QR code, money flows to your Stripe account minus the fee.
External link	The show is listed and shareable, but the ticket button sends fans to your own ticketing URL. No Stripe, no fee.

THE ONE HARD REQUIREMENT

A **paid** show sold on MadGigz needs payouts in the **Ready** state. If they are not, the form blocks with "*Connect a payout account to sell paid tickets, or set the price to 0*". **Free shows (price 0) do not need Stripe at all** — a useful way to list your first gig while verification finishes.

8 What you keep per ticket ARTIST

The price you set is exactly what the fan pays — no fees are bolted on at checkout. MadGigz's commission comes out of your side: **5% of the ticket, with a 25¢ minimum, plus 21% Spanish IVA on that commission** (the IVA is tax on our service fee, collected for Hacienda, not a tax on your ticket). The Add Show form shows this live as you type a price.

TICKET PRICE	COMMISSION	IVA ON COMMISSION	TOTAL DEDUCTED	YOU RECEIVE
€3.00	€0.25 (minimum)	€0.05	€0.30	€2.70
€5.00	€0.25	€0.05	€0.30	€4.70
€10.00	€0.50	€0.11	€0.61	€9.39
€20.00	€1.00	€0.21	€1.21	€18.79
€25.00	€1.25	€0.26	€1.51	€23.49

Rates are configuration, not hard-coded — if the platform fee, IVA rate or minimum changes, every screen and every charge changes together.

9 On the night – scanning ARTIST

Profile → **Scan Tickets** opens the camera scanner. Point it at a fan's ticket QR and it answers with one of four results:

Valid	Let them in — the ticket is marked checked in.
Already used	This QR has been scanned before. Same screenshot doing the rounds.
Cancelled	Refunded or from a cancelled show. Not valid for entry.
Invalid	Not a MadGigz ticket.

Bring a charged phone and expect patchy venue Wi-Fi — the scanner needs a connection to check each ticket.

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Getting paid ADMIN

Ticket money lands in **your** Stripe balance as each sale completes — you can watch it accumulate under **View payouts on Stripe**. It is held there until **after your show has happened**, then released to your bank by MadGigz.

WHY IT IS HELD

So that a cancelled show can always be refunded in full. Without the hold, ticket money could be withdrawn before the gig and fans left out of pocket. Once your event date has passed, the balance is released; from there it is Stripe's normal bank timing.

If a show is cancelled, every ticket is refunded automatically through Stripe and the capacity is returned.

Stripe sandbox test run

Rehearse Part 1 end to end against a Stripe sandbox. Nothing here touches real money, real cards or real bank accounts — and every verification decision can be forced to the outcome you want to see, including failure.

A · Sandbox and environment setup

In the Stripe Dashboard, open the account picker → **Sandboxes** → create one (or reuse the existing MadGigz sandbox). Everything below happens inside it. Keys from a sandbox start with `sk_test_` / `pk_test_`; they cannot move real money even by accident.

Connect must be enabled in the sandbox (Dashboard → Connect → get started) before Express accounts can be created.

Environment variables

VARIABLE	VALUE FOR TESTING
STRIPE_SECRET_KEY	Sandbox secret key (<code>sk_test_...</code>)
STRIPE_WEBHOOK_SECRET	Signing secret for platform events
STRIPE_WEBHOOK_SECRET_CONNECT	Signing secret for connected-account events
NEXT_PUBLIC_APP_URL	<code>http://localhost:3000</code> — Stripe redirects back here after onboarding
NEXT_PUBLIC_MADGIGZ_FEE_PERCENT	5 (default if unset)
NEXT_PUBLIC_MADGIGZ_VAT_PERCENT	21 (default if unset)
NEXT_PUBLIC_MADGIGZ_MIN_FEE_CENTS	25 (default if unset)

SET THE APP URL BEFORE ANYTHING ELSE

It is what Stripe sends the artist back to after onboarding. Point it at the wrong host and onboarding "works" but the app never refreshes the payout status, so the badge sits on **Pending** forever and you will chase a bug that isn't there.

B · Webhooks – remember there are two

Stripe delivers **platform** events (`checkout.session.*`) and **connected-account** events (`account.updated`) to separate destinations with separate signing secrets. Both point at the same route, `/api/stripe/webhook`, which accepts a delivery that verifies against either secret. Miss the Connect one and payout status will never update by itself.

Locally, forward both with the Stripe CLI:

```
# one listener, both event streams, one signing secret
stripe listen \
  --forward-to http://localhost:3000/api/stripe/webhook \
  --forward-connect-to http://localhost:3000/api/stripe/webhook

# it prints: Ready! Your webhook signing secret is whsec_...
# put that in STRIPE_WEBHOOK_SECRET and restart next dev
```

On a deployed preview, create the two endpoints in the sandbox Dashboard instead — one "Events on your account", one "Events on connected accounts" — and paste each secret into the matching variable.

EVENT	WHAT THE APP DOES WITH IT
checkout.session.completed	Issues the ticket — but only if <code>payment_status = paid</code>
checkout.session.async_payment_succeeded	Issues the ticket for delayed methods
checkout.session.expired / async_payment_failed	Returns the held seats to capacity
account.updated	Recomputes whether the artist may sell

C · Test run 1 – connect payouts with test data

Sign up a throwaway artist (Part 1, steps 2–4), approve them from `/admin/artists`, then press **Connect payouts**. Stripe's hosted form opens with a test-mode banner. Fill it with these values rather than anything real — they are Stripe's documented triggers, and they resolve instantly.

FIELD	VALUE	RESULT
Country	Spain	Fixed by the app — accounts are created as <code>country: ES</code>
Business type	Individual	Fewest fields; matches a solo artist
Phone number	0000000000	Passes validation
SMS code	000-000	Accepted as the verification code (enter as <code>000000</code>)
Date of birth	1901-01-01	Successful DOB match. <code>1902-01-01</code> matches immediately (no webhook wait)
Personal ID number	000000000	Successful ID match
Business tax ID	000000000	Successful business ID match (only if you chose company)
Address	any plausible address	Not verified in test
IBAN	ES0700120345030000067890	Spain test account — payouts succeed
ID document	success.png	Stripe's verified test image, if a document is requested

Stripe's verified/unverified test document images are served from the docs CDN — download `success.png` once and keep it next to your test notes:

```
curl -O https://d37ugbyn3rpeym.cloudfront.net/docs/identity/success.png # verifies
curl -O https://d37ugbyn3rpeym.cloudfront.net/docs/identity/failed.png # fails
```

Driving it through the API instead of the browser? Attach `file_identity_document_success` (or `..._failure`) as the document file token.

What to check when you land back on the profile

- ☐ You are returned to `/profile? payout=return` and the settings sheet opens by itself.
- ☐ The Payouts badge reads **Ready** and the button becomes **View payouts on Stripe**.
- ☐ The connected account in the Stripe Dashboard shows the **transfers** capability as *active* — that specific capability is the gate, not *charges enabled*.
- ☐ Its payout schedule is **Manual**. The app sets this deliberately so money cannot leave before the gig.
- ☐ The profile row's `stripe_payouts_ready` is `true`.

D · Simulating a verification that does *not* pass

The Pending state is the one users actually get stuck in, so test it on purpose. Start a second throwaway artist and substitute one value:

SUBSTITUTE	SIMULATES
ID number 111111111	Identity mismatch — verification fails
ID number 111111113	Inactive ID number
DOB 1900-01-01	OFAC sanctions-list alert
document failed.png	Unverifiable ID document
IBAN ES9121000418450200051332	Payout later fails with <code>no_account</code>

Expected behaviour: `account.updated` fires, transfers stay inactive, and the badge shows **Pending** with a **Finish setup** button and the line *"Stripe still needs a few details before you can sell."* Then confirm the recovery path — open Add Show, set a price above zero, and the form must refuse with the connect-a-payout-account error while still allowing a €0 show.

Finally, press **Finish setup**, correct the ID to `000000000`, and watch the badge flip to Ready. That flip should happen from the webhook alone, without a page reload trick.

TESTING THE WEBHOOK IN ISOLATION

You do not have to redo onboarding to exercise the handler. With the CLI listening, edit the connected account in the sandbox Dashboard — any change emits `account.updated` to the Connect stream, and the app should rewrite `stripe_payouts_ready` to match. Admin also has a **reset payout account** action on `/admin/artists` to detach a test account and start clean.

E · Test run 2 – sell a ticket

As the approved, payouts-ready artist, add a paid show (say €10, capacity 5, max 2 per order). Sign in as a fan account and buy one.

CARD NUMBER	OUTCOME TO VERIFY
4242 4242 4242 4242	Success. Ticket issued with QR, capacity drops, artist balance rises.
4000 0000 0000 0077	Success, funds land directly in the available balance — use this one when you want to test the payout release without waiting.
4000 0000 0000 0002	Generic decline. No ticket, capacity returned.
4000 0000 0000 9995	Insufficient funds decline.
4000 0025 0000 3155	3D Secure challenge — complete it, then abandon it, and check both paths.
4000 0000 0000 0259	Succeeds then is disputed as fraudulent.

Any future expiry, any 3-digit CVC, any postcode.

- ☐ Fee split matches the table in Part 1 — for €10: fan pays €10.00, application fee €0.61, artist receives €9.39.
- ☐ The payment is a destination charge: the artist's connected account is the transfer destination, not MadGigz.
- ☐ The ticket appears in the fan's profile with a scannable QR.
- ☐ Buying more than *max per order* is refused; buying past capacity is refused.

- ☐ Abandon a checkout and let it expire — the held seats come back.
- ☐ Scan the QR from the artist's device: **Valid** first time, **Already used** second.

F · Test run 3 – release a payout

Artist accounts run on a **manual** payout schedule, so nothing reaches a bank until an admin releases it. Open `/admin/payouts`.

1. Find the artist. Check **Available** and **Pending** — money paid by an ordinary test card sits in Pending for a few days first; money from `4000000000000077` is Available immediately.
2. Confirm the page lists the show under **Upcoming events** and treat that as a hold signal — the whole point is releasing only after the gig.
3. Backdate the event, reload, and it should move to **Past events** with "None — safe to release" against upcoming.
4. Press **Release**. Expect a payout for the full available balance in EUR.
5. Press it twice quickly — the second press must not create a second payout. Same account, same amount, same day is deduplicated.
6. Release with a zero balance — expect "Nothing available to pay out yet", not an error.
7. Repeat with the `no_account` IBAN from section D to see a failed payout handled cleanly.

G · Test run 4 – refunds and cancellation

- ☐ Refund a single ticket from `/admin/billing`; the fan's ticket goes to cancelled and the scanner rejects it.
- ☐ Cancel a show with no tickets — it is deleted outright.
- ☐ Cancel a show with tickets — it is soft-cancelled and every ticket refunded through Stripe, with capacity returned.
- ☐ Cancel a **free** show — tickets are voided with no Stripe call.
- ☐ Release a payout *before* testing a cancellation refund and confirm the failure is visible: this is exactly the hole the hold policy exists to prevent.

H · Full QA checklist

#	STEP	PASS CONDITION
1	Artist signup	Under-16 DOB rejected; duplicate username rejected; Turnstile enforced
2	Email confirm	Spent link lands on sign-in with the reassuring notice, not an error
3	Claim profile	Blocks with no social and no evidence; evidence not publicly readable
4	Pending state	No Add Show, no scanner; "Under review" card shown
5	Approval	Status email sent; artist tools appear
6	Connect payouts	Ready badge; transfers active; manual schedule
7	Failed verification	Pending badge; Finish setup returns to the outstanding item
8	Free show while pending	€0 show can be created without Stripe
9	Paid show gate	Blocked until payouts are Ready
10	Checkout	Ticket issued only on paid; fee split correct
11	Capacity	Expired/failed checkouts return seats
12	Scanner	Valid / already used / cancelled / invalid all reachable
13	Payout release	Full balance paid; double-press deduplicated
14	Refunds	Per-ticket and whole-show refunds both land

I · Known traps

TRAP	WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENS
Only one webhook secret set	Payments work, payout status never updates on its own. Both secrets, always.
Account Link reused	Onboarding links are single-use and expire in minutes. A fresh one is minted on every press of Connect — never bookmark one.
Sandbox-to-sandbox Connect	Stripe does not allow connections between a platform sandbox and connected-account sandboxes. Onboard test accounts through the hosted flow, not by linking another sandbox.
Waiting for the balance	Ordinary test cards land in Pending. Use <code>40000000000000077</code> when the payout release is what you are testing.
Expecting an automatic payout	There isn't one, by design. Manual schedule; admin releases.
Non-Spanish test IBANs	Accounts are created as <code>country: ES</code> . A test IBAN from another country will be rejected.
Checking artist role only	Role alone grants nothing — <code>artist_status = approved</code> is enforced in the database, so a role-only test account will hit refusals, not a UI bug.
Test keys in chat logs	Sandbox keys still deserve rotating if they leak into a transcript. Roll them and move on.

Test values in Part 2 are Stripe's own documented triggers — see docs.stripe.com/connect/testing, docs.stripe.com/testing and docs.stripe.com/sandboxes. Fee figures assume the default 5% commission, 21% IVA and 25¢ minimum; they follow whatever the deployment is configured with.